

Philosophy, Literature & Religion Themes

Schools of philosophy, classical literature and religious traditions for surprise PYQs.

Portion focus ~26% · Topic: culture-lit

PYQ themes: Darshanas · Literature · Bhakti literature

Why UPSC asks this

Lower count, high surprise — breadth beats depth.

Philosophy

One-line essence of Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Samkhya, Yoga, Mimamsa, Vedanta. Avoid over-subtlety.

Literature

Author–text pairs that recur; religious literature as social history source.

Must remember

- Six astika schools overview; Charvaka/Buddhist/Jaina nastika labels in textbook framing
- Sangam, Sanskrit mahakavya, Bhakti vernaculars

Educational prioritisation heuristic — not an official UPSC prediction. © UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.